H2: Comprehensive Project: Assessment Rubric

This rubric is shared with you so you know exactly what we're looking for. Your tutor uses the same rubric to assess your project.

How assessment works

Your project is assessed on **five dimensions**. Each dimension is rated at one of three levels:

- **Fix and Resubmit**: revision needed before this dimension passes
- **Meets HD Standard**: this dimension passes
- **Exceeds**: this dimension is notably strong

To pass H2: You must reach "Meets HD Standard" on **all five dimensions**. If any dimension is "Fix and Resubmit," you'll be asked to revise.

Within-band grading (80–90+): The number of "Exceeds" ratings differentiates within the HD band. All "Meets" = solid HD. Multiple "Exceeds" = strong HD.

The five dimensions

1. Problem & Approach

Is the problem non-trivial? Is the technique a good fit?

Fix and Resubmit	Meets HD Standard	Exceeds
Problem is trivially simple, or technique doesn't fit the problem. This could have been an earlier task submission with a different dataset.	Problem is non-trivial. Technique is justified: you can explain why *this* technique for *this* problem. The project goes clearly beyond earlier task scope.	Problem is genuinely novel or the technique is adapted in a surprising way. The choice of problem reveals insight about the technique's strengths or limitations.

What tutors look for: In the H3 interview, can you explain why you chose this approach over alternatives? If you say "because it was in the course" without further justification, that's "Fix and Resubmit."

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2. Implementation

Does it work? Do you understand it?

Fix and Resubmit	Meets HD Standard	Exceeds
Code doesn't run, or you can't explain key functions when asked in the H3 interview.	Code runs, is reproducible (random seeds set, dependencies documented), and you can walk through the core algorithm explaining each decision.	Code is well-structured with clear functions, handles edge cases, and shows deliberate design choices beyond the minimum (e.g., modular design, helper functions, meaningful variable names).

What tutors look for: In the discussion, they'll ask "show me a piece of code you're proud of and explain why it works." If you can't explain your own code, that's "Fix and Resubmit" regardless of what's written in the report.

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3. Evaluation

Did you test it rigorously? Are you honest about failures?

Fix and Resubmit	Meets HD Standard	Exceeds
One experiment with no parameter variation, or claims "everything works" with no evidence of testing failure cases.	Two or more experiments that vary meaningful parameters. Results are analysed honestly: failures are named and explained, not hidden.	Evaluation reveals something unexpected and you investigate *why*, not just *what*. Includes comparison against a baseline or alternative approach.

What "meaningful parameter" means: Changing a random seed is not a meaningful experiment. Varying the learning rate and showing convergence vs divergence IS. Varying the heuristic and showing how path quality changes IS. The experiment should teach you something about the technique.

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4. Reflection

Do you understand the limits? Do you see the ethical stakes?

Fix and Resubmit	Meets HD Standard	Exceeds
Generic "AI has risks" or limitations section is absent/says "none." AI use statement is "I used ChatGPT" with no detail.	Names 4+ specific limitations of your approach. Ethical reflection connects to a named concept from C2 (fairness) or C4 (deployment). AI use statement distinguishes what you did vs what AI did.	Limitations reveal genuine understanding of where and why the approach breaks. Ethical reflection identifies a specific tension (not just a risk). AI use statement shows you caught an AI error or made a deliberate choice to reject AI advice.

What "specific limitation" means: "My model could be improved" is not specific. "The classifier fails on messages shorter than 5 words because the bag-of-words representation has too few features to distinguish spam from ham" IS specific. Name the condition, explain the mechanism.

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5. Communication

Is the report clear? Do the visualisations support the argument?

Fix and Resubmit	Meets HD Standard	Exceeds
Report under 1000 words or missing sections. Visualisations are present but not referenced in the text.	Report ~1500 words covering all 6 sections. Visualisations are referenced in the analysis and support the argument. Code has enough documentation to follow.	Report reads as a coherent narrative: each section builds on the previous. Visualisations are designed to illuminate a specific point, not just show that code ran.

What "referenced in the analysis" means: Don't just generate a plot and move on. In your Results section, say "Figure 1 shows that accuracy drops sharply when the learning rate exceeds 0.1, this is because…" The visualisation and the text should work together.

Quick self-check before submitting

Dimension	Minimum for "Meets HD Standard"
Problem & Approach	Non-trivial, justified, beyond earlier task work
Implementation	Runs, reproducible, you can explain it
Evaluation	2+ meaningful experiments, honest about failures
Reflection	4+ specific limitations, C2/C4 connection, AI use detailed
Communication	~1500 words, all sections, visualisations referenced

If you can check all five, you're ready to submit. The H3 interview will test Implementation and Evaluation, so make sure you genuinely understand your code and results.

FIT1061 H2: Assessment Rubric (Student Version)